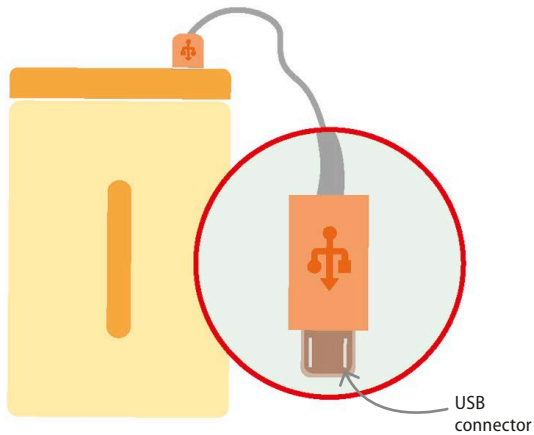




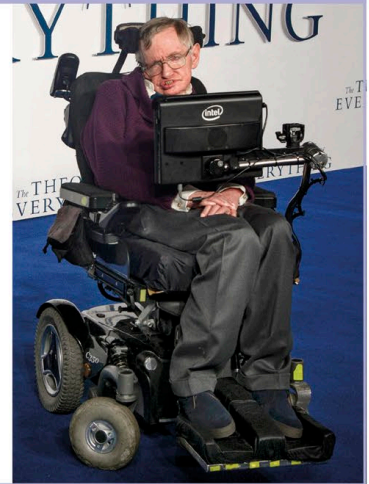
△ Removable hard drive

If a computer is low on storage space, or if a user needs to work on different computers at different locations, a removable hard drive is often the most efficient solution. It works just like an internal hard drive, but is portable.

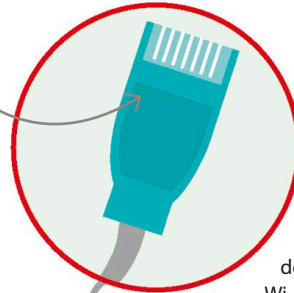
IN DEPTH

Controlling computers

Peripherals are crucially important to people with disabilities as they allow them to use computers. English theoretical physicist Stephen Hawking (1942–2018) suffered from motor neurone disease, which attacked his muscles and left him unable to speak or move. Engineers and software developers made it possible for him to communicate by attaching a sensor to the one muscle he could still move on his cheek. This was connected to a speech-generating machine.

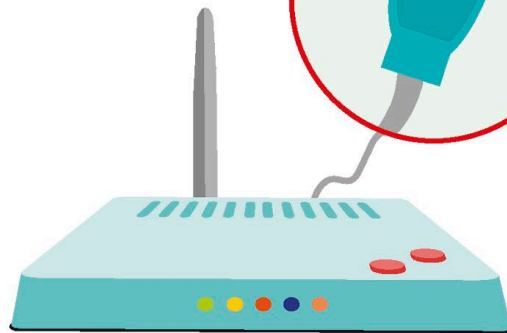


Ethernet cables control the passing of information between computers to avoid simultaneous transmission.

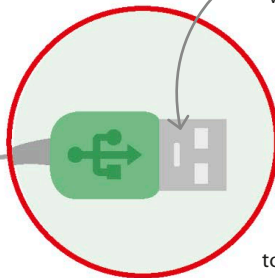


◁ Router

Routers send and receive data packets between computers, and as such, they are both input and output devices. Routers can connect devices within a home together, or they can be used to connect a home network to the internet. It is common for most home devices to connect to a home router via Wi-Fi, but if there is a problem with the Wi-Fi signal, an Ethernet cable can often be used.



Keyboards and mice are connected to the computer via USB cables.



◁ Monitor, keyboard, and mouse

These three are perhaps the most common peripheral devices. Monitors visually display information processed by the computer. A keyboard and a mouse are input devices that allow users to interact with a computer. Sometimes a touch-sensitive panel called a touchpad can be used instead of a mouse.

